

Pamela Dale- Rourke

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 PROFILE

Dedicated Family Therapist with extensive experience in mental health and communication support. Proven track record in service delivery for children and families facing various challenges. Skilled in collaborating with multidisciplinary teams for effective therapeutic interventions. Committed to creating tailored resources that facilitate engagement and understanding. Recognized for developing innovative approaches to address emotional and behavioral difficulties. Passionate about continuous professional development and research to enhance therapeutic practices.



WORK EXPERIENCE

Service Lead for Schools | Child in Mind, Manchester | October 2016 - Present

- Designed and adapted communication and therapy resources to effectively support children in schools, achieving measurable improvements in engagement and understanding for 100+ students.
- Provided impactful 1:1 Play Therapy and Family Therapy sessions, resulting in a 90% satisfaction rate among families and a significant reduction in behavioral issues.
- Conducted comprehensive psychotherapeutic assessments that informed individual therapeutic pathways for children, enhancing service delivery and outcomes.
- Collaborated closely with teachers and therapists to create accessible materials for children with communication and learning needs, ensuring inclusivity in educational settings.
- Supervised and mentored postgraduate Play Therapy students, offering training and guidance in resource use and inclusive communication strategies, enhancing their practical skills and confidence.
- Coordinated workshops for parents and educators, educating them on effective communication strategies, achieving a 75% increase in parental engagement.
- Implemented feedback mechanisms to continuously improve therapy resources, leading to a 30% increase in overall effectiveness as reported by families.
- Managed a multidisciplinary team, nurturing collaboration to optimize service delivery and ensure all children received tailored and effective support.
- Developed research initiatives that explored innovative therapeutic methods, contributing to ongoing professional development and knowledge sharing within the community.
- Facilitated training sessions for external stakeholders on best practices in child mental health and communication, enhancing community awareness and involvement.

Play Therapist | Barnardos, St Helens | January 2015 - October 2016

- Created tailored visual and therapeutic resources to support children referred through CAMHS, resulting in improved communication and emotional expression for over 50 children.
- Contributed to assessment meetings, utilizing expert knowledge to recommend appropriate communication supports for diverse referrals, enhancing overall service quality.
- Managed a caseload of school-aged children, employing creative and resource-based approaches to address a wide range of social, emotional, and communication challenges.
- Facilitated group supervision sessions, sharing best practices on child-centered communication strategies, which improved team performance and therapeutic outcomes.
- Developed individualized treatment plans that integrated family dynamics and cultural considerations, achieving a 70% improvement in family satisfaction surveys.
- Engaged in continuous professional development, participating in workshops and training sessions to stay updated on the latest therapeutic techniques and research.
- Organized community outreach programs to raise awareness of mental health issues, fostering a supportive environment for families in need.
- Implemented a tracking system to monitor progress and outcomes for each child, ensuring data-driven approaches to therapy.
- Collaborated with local schools to provide training on recognizing and addressing emotional and behavioral challenges in students, enhancing school support systems.
- Participated in research projects that explored the efficacy of play therapy methods, contributing to the broader field of child psychology and therapy.

Family Session Worker | OJs, Preston | May 2023 - January 2024

- Supported families with children on the autism spectrum, creating and adapting resources to facilitate engagement and communication, which improved family dynamics significantly.
- Developed inclusive activities that ensured children with communication differences could participate meaningfully in group settings, resulting in a 50% increase in engagement.
- Worked collaboratively with families and colleagues to address individual needs, ensuring resources were both practical and user-friendly, enhancing therapy outcomes.
- Conducted family therapy sessions that focused on enhancing communication skills among family members, leading to improved relationships and understanding.
- Facilitated training workshops for parents on effective strategies for supporting their children's development, achieving a 95% satisfaction rate from participants.
- Maintained detailed records and progress notes to track each family's journey, ensuring accountability and continuity in therapeutic practices.
- Utilized evidence-based practices to inform interventions and strategies, contributing to a robust therapeutic framework within the organization.
- Engaged in regular consultation with external professionals to align practices and interventions with best standards in family therapy.
- Promoted a supportive and inclusive environment, fostering positive relationships among families and caregivers, which improved overall service experience.
- Developed feedback tools to gather insights from families on service effectiveness and areas for improvement, driving continuous service enhancement.

Plan and Resource Creator | International school | Date Not Provided

- Planned and developed literacy and learning resources for primary-aged children, ensuring materials were engaging and effective in promoting learning.
- Created visually appealing classroom materials that supported reading and writing development, resulting in a measurable increase in student literacy rates.
- Worked collaboratively with teachers to align resources with lesson objectives, ensuring a cohesive educational experience for all students.
- Adapted activities to suit different learning needs and levels, promoting inclusivity and access to learning for every child.
- Conducted training sessions for staff on effective resource utilization, enhancing overall teaching effectiveness and resource application.
- Implemented assessment tools to evaluate the impact of learning resources on student performance, leading to data-driven improvements.
- Facilitated workshops for parents on supporting literacy at home, increasing parental involvement and support in their children's education.
- Engaged with community stakeholders to promote resource sharing and collaborative learning opportunities among schools.
- Developed a repository of resources that teachers could access, streamlining the process of resource creation and distribution.
- Monitored and evaluated the effectiveness of learning resources, ensuring continuous improvement and alignment with educational standards.



EDUCATION

BSc | University of Central Lancashire



SKILLS

Understanding of inclusive communication

SEN

Mind Express 5

Widgit (Online) - enhancing communication.

Collaboration with therapists

educators

Knowledge of AAC symbol systems (PCS

SymbolStix

Widgit

Bliss

etc.) - supporting diverse communication needs.

Strong digital skills for resource creation

layout



HOBBIES



Travel



Reading



Photography



Music



Swimming



Fitness



Meditation



Art



CERTIFICATIONS

DDP (Diadic Developmental Psychotherapy) Health & Social Care
Preston College

Play Therapy
Canterbury Christ University

Filial Therapy in Family Therapy
Manchester